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FREE CHECKLIST · 2026 EDITION

Payment Gateway Setup Cheat Sheet (With Expert Tips)

Feeling stuck on how to actually get paid for your online sales? You are not alone. Setting up payments can seem technical, but it does not have to be.



6 pages · PDF

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What’s inside

3 short sections. Read it in order, or jump to the part you need today.

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Feeling stuck on how to actually get paid for your online sales? You are not alone. Setting up payments can seem technical, but it does not have to be.

A payment gateway is the service that collects money from your customer (by card, bank transfer or USSD) and sends it to your bank account. This cheat sheet breaks the setup into five simple steps. Follow it, and you will have a safe payment system ready for your first customer in no time.

01 Your 5-Step Payment Gateway Setup Checklist

Think of this as your checklist before you launch your online store.

Step 1: Choose Your Payment Gateway

- The task: Pick the service that will collect payments from your customers.
- How to: Choose one that works well in Nigeria and supports cards, bank transfer and USSD. Paystack and Flutterwave are the most common. Moniepoint and OPay are popular for transfers and POS. If your store platform already includes payments, use that first. For example, Shopinbos stores come with payments built in, and payments settle straight to your bank.
- Expert tip: Start simple. Do not waste weeks comparing ten providers. Pick one, get it working, and add others later. Use PayPal only if you sell to customers abroad.

Step 2: Create Your Business Account

- The task: Sign up for a business account with your chosen gateway. Do not run business sales through a personal account.
- How to: Go to the provider's website (for example paystack.com or flutterwave.com) and click "Sign up" or "Create account". The form will guide you.
- Expert tip: Have your details ready. You will usually need your CAC registration (business name or limited company), business address, TIN, your BVN, and a valid ID such as your NIN slip, driver's licence or international passport. Having these on your phone or laptop makes the process smooth.

Step 3: Verify Your Account and Identity

- The task: Prove to the gateway that your business is real. This protects you and your customers.
- How to: The provider will guide you. It usually means confirming your email and phone number, entering your BVN, and uploading your CAC documents and ID.
- Expert tip: Be patient. Verification can take a few days, and until it is done you may only be able to use "test mode" or have low limits. Do this step before you launch, so you are not stuck when your first order comes in.

Step 4: Connect Your Bank Account

- The task: Tell the gateway where to send your money.
- How to: In your gateway dashboard, find “Settlements”, “Payouts” or “Bank Accounts”. Enter your bank name and 10-digit account number (NUBAN). The account name must match your business or BVN name.
- Expert tip: Use a business bank account. Keeping business and personal money separate makes it easy to see your profit, file taxes and prove your business is real if a bank or customer asks.

Step 5: Connect the Gateway to Your Online Store

- The task: Make the “Pay now” button on your store talk to your payment gateway.
- How to: This sounds technical, but most platforms make it easy. Go to your store settings, find “Payments”, and follow the steps to connect your gateway, usually by pasting in the keys from your gateway dashboard.
- Expert tip: Test before you go live! Most gateways have a “test mode”. Use it to place a pretend order and check that everything works, from tapping “Pay” to the customer getting a confirmation by email or WhatsApp. Then make one small real payment to be sure.

02 Expert Security and Fraud Prevention Tips

Once you are set up, protecting your hard-earned money matters. Here are three non-negotiable tips.

1. Confirm every payment in your dashboard or bank app.
    - Never send goods because of a screenshot or a “debit alert” the customer forwards you. Fake transfer alerts are common. Only ship when the money shows in your gateway dashboard or business bank account.
2. Be careful with changed delivery details.
    - If a customer pays and then suddenly asks you to deliver to a different person, address or state, call them to confirm before you send anything. Treat pressure and excuses as a red flag.
3. Be wary of large, rushed orders.
    - Big orders are great, but be extra careful with high-value orders from new customers who push for urgent delivery, offer to “overpay”, or ask for a refund to a different account. For pay on delivery, ask for a small commitment fee on big or far-away orders.

03 Your Quick-Reference Cheat Sheet

Screenshot this or print it and stick it on your wall!

Step	Task	Key Question to Ask	Status
1	Choose Gateway	“Does it take cards, transfer and USSD in Nigeria?”	☐
2	Create Business Account	“Do I have my CAC documents, TIN, BVN and ID ready?”	☐
3	Verify Identity	“Have I completed all the verification steps?”	☐
4	Connect Bank Account	“Is my business bank account linked and name matching?”	☐
5	Connect to Store & TEST	“Did I place a successful test order?”	☐

You have got this! By following these steps, you are not just installing a tool. You are building a safe, reliable way for your business to get paid. Now go get that first sale!

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Ready to make your first sale?

Rex builds your store with you in 5 minutes. Take card, transfer and pay on delivery, book riders, and let Peggy answer customers on WhatsApp.

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